

Team Collaboration & Auto-Deployment Guide

This repository powers the **EstatePro Reporting System** website, live at:

👉 <https://enoghayinmartins5-sys.github.io/estate-report/>

It is set up for **continuous deployment**: whenever a change reaches the `main` branch, a GitHub Actions workflow automatically publishes it to the live site within a minute or two. No one has to deploy anything by hand.

1. How the auto-deployment works

- The workflow file lives at `.github/workflows/deploy.yml` (`.github/workflows/deploy.yml`).
- It runs on **every push / merge to `main`**.
- Steps:
 1. **Validate** – checks that `index.html` exists and `reports.json` is valid JSON.
 2. **Deploy** – publishes the site to GitHub Pages.
- You can watch every deployment under the repository's **Actions** tab.

✅ Result: when any staff member's change lands on `main`, everyone sees it on the live website automatically.

⚙️ **One-time setup:** In **Settings** → **Pages** → **Build and deployment** → **Source**, select **GitHub Actions** (instead of "Deploy from a branch"). This tells GitHub Pages to use the workflow above.

2. Adding team members as collaborators

Only the repository **owner/admin** (`enoghayinmartins5-sys`) can do this.

1. Open the repository on GitHub:
`https://github.com/enoghayinmartins5-sys/estate-report`
2. Click **Settings** (top menu).
3. In the left sidebar, click **Collaborators** (under Access).
- GitHub may ask you to confirm your password.
4. Click **Add people**.
5. Type the teammate's **GitHub username or email** and select them.
6. Choose a role — for staff who edit the site, pick **Write**.
7. Click **Add [name] to this repository**.
8. The teammate receives an email/GitHub invite and must **Accept** it.

Recommended roles

Role	What they can do	Use for
Read	View only	Viewers / auditors
Write	Push branches, open & merge PRs, edit files	Most staff editors
Maintain	Write + manage some settings	Team leads
Admin	Full control incl. settings & collaborators	Owner / IT admin

💡 For larger teams, create a **GitHub Organization** and use **Teams** to manage many people at once instead of adding them one by one.

3. Collaboration workflow for staff

There are two supported ways to make changes. Choose based on comfort level.

Option A — Quick edit directly on GitHub (easiest, no tools)

Best for small text/report edits.

1. Go to the file on GitHub (e.g. `index.html` or `reports.json`).
2. Click the **pencil (🖋️ Edit)** icon.
3. Make your changes.
4. Scroll down, add a short **commit message** describing the change.
5. Choose **“Commit directly to the `main` branch”**.
6. Click **Commit changes**.
7. 🎉 The site auto-deploys — refresh the live URL after ~1-2 minutes.

Option B — Branch + Pull Request (recommended for safety / review)

Best when you want a teammate to review before it goes live.

```
# 1. Clone once (first time only)
git clone https://github.com/enoghayinmartins5-sys/estate-report.git
cd estate-report

# 2. Always start from the latest main
git checkout main
git pull origin main

# 3. Create a branch for your change
git checkout -b my-change-description

# 4. Edit files, then stage & commit
git add .
git commit -m "Describe what you changed"

# 5. Push your branch
git push origin my-change-description
```

Then on GitHub:

1. Click **Compare & pull request**.
2. Add a title/description and click **Create pull request**.
3. A teammate reviews and clicks **Merge pull request**.
4. On merge, the site **auto-deploys** to the live URL.

4. Golden rules to avoid conflicts

- **Always** `git pull origin main` **before you start editing**. This keeps you in sync with everyone else's latest changes.
 - **Make small, frequent commits** with clear messages.
 - If Git reports a **merge conflict**, it means two people edited the same lines. Open the file, keep the correct version, remove the `<<<< / ===== / >>>>` markers, then commit again.
 - Check the **Actions** tab if a change doesn't appear — a red **✗** means the deployment failed (usually invalid JSON in `reports.json`).
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5. Important note about report data

The website currently stores the reports you create **in each browser's local storage** (on the individual staff member's device). That data is **not** automatically shared between staff or committed to this repository.

To make reports truly shared across the whole team, the data needs to be saved back into the repository (e.g. committing `reports.json`) or into a shared backend/database. If you'd like every staff member to see the same live report data automatically, ask your developer to enable one of those options — the deployment pipeline in this repo is already ready to publish it once it's saved.

6. Quick reference

Task	Where
Live website	https://enoghayinmartins5-sys.github.io/estate-report/
Add collaborators	Settings → Collaborators → Add people
Watch deployments	Actions tab
Deployment config	<code>.github/workflows/deploy.yml</code>
Set Pages source	Settings → Pages → Source → GitHub Actions